

The Solution

A recurring, First Nations-designed workforce protection system built to detect colonial load early, before it becomes a departure or a claim.

WHAT WIRRAH IS

Wirrah is a structured workforce protection system, purpose-built to identify and manage colonial load in First Nations workplaces. It runs every week and every fortnight, inside your organisation's existing Microsoft 365 environment, using tools your staff already have access to. No new software. No external platform. No new vendor relationship for IT to manage.

The mechanism is straightforward: give staff a culturally safe, consistent way to speak up. Detect the early signals before they become a departure or a workers' compensation claim. Put a plain-language report in the hands of the CEO or MD so they can act. Repeat, fortnightly.

The program is designed and led by First Nations practitioners. It is owned 51 percent by Tanika Perry, a Worimi and Bundjalung woman and Wirrah's Managing Director. The cultural authority that shapes the program is not contracted in as an add-on. It is the foundation of the organisation.

WHAT IT IS NOT

- ✗ Not an AI product. No algorithm interprets your staff's responses. A First Nations-led expert panel does.
- ✗ Not a chatbot or app. Nothing for staff to download, log into, or learn.
- ✗ Not a generic EAP. Wirrah is not a referral service or a helpline.
- ✗ Not a cultural awareness training program. Training is a one-off. Wirrah is a recurring system.
- ✗ Not an external platform. All data stays inside your organisation's own Microsoft 365 environment.

HOW IT WORKS

Wirrah operates through three components. Each is culturally grounded. Each runs inside tools your staff already use. Together they create a closed loop: staff speak, signals are detected, leadership acts.

01

Culturally safe check-in

Each week, staff receive a brief, culturally grounded check-in through your existing Microsoft Teams channels. It is not a survey. It is a consistent, safe point of contact that builds the trust

02

Early signals survey

Every two weeks, staff complete a short anonymous survey through Microsoft Forms. Responses are reviewed by a First Nations-led expert panel, who produce a plain-language

03

Readiness Assessment

At the start of engagement, Wirrah conducts a structured Readiness Assessment. It gives leadership a baseline: where colonial load is concentrated, which parts of the organisation are under

staff need to speak up when something is not right.

report for the CEO or MD: here is what the early signals show, here is what to act on.

the most pressure, and what to address first. Most organisations have never had this view.

WHAT THE LEADER RECEIVES

The primary output is a fortnightly plain-language report delivered directly to the CEO or MD. The First Nations-led expert panel interprets the data and writes the report. The leader does not need to run a dashboard or translate findings. They receive a clear picture and a clear action.

Fortnightly plain-language report

A human-written summary of early signals, with specific recommended actions. Written by the First Nations-led expert panel, not generated by software.

Early departure signals

Patterns that precede a departure become visible before the resignation arrives. Earlier visibility means earlier intervention.

Colonial load visibility

A structured, recurring view of where colonial load is concentrated in the organisation. Updated fortnightly. Most organisations do not have this at all.

Documented record of action

A timestamped record that the organisation identified psychosocial risk and acted on it. Defensible under Australian WHS law.

No new technology to manage

The system runs entirely within Microsoft 365. Staff and IT carry no additional platform burden.

WHY IT IS BUILT THIS WAY

Generic workforce frameworks ask First Nations organisations to adapt themselves to a system that was designed for someone else. The burden of that adaptation falls on the same people who are already carrying colonial load. The tool meant to help compounds the problem it is supposed to address.

Wirrah starts from the other direction. The check-in content, the survey questions, the assessment framework, and the reporting language were all designed for First Nations workplaces first. The expertise that reviews the data is First Nations-led. The organisation that delivers the system is First Nations majority-owned.

The result is a system your staff will engage with because it was built for them, and a record your leadership can stand behind because it was built to be sustained.

REVIEW NOTE: The description of the First Nations-led expert panel (Component 02) requires validation by Tanika and Paula before this document is sent to Sam or any funder. The panel structure, title, and composition have not yet been formally agreed.